

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Owner, industrial platform delivery.*

Positioning, ten years of end-to-end product ownership in regulated, complex technical environments, now available to stabilise and scale a connected-device platform.

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§ WHY THIS ROLE

The client is building a multi-team product organisation around connected professional devices, and the explicit ask is to professionalise Discovery and Delivery processes while keeping feature quality high across interdependent Scrum teams. That is a precise match for the work I did at Emil Group, where I rebuilt sprint discipline, split an oversized team into effective Scrum units, and recovered client trust from near-zero – in a similarly multi-team, microservice-adjacent environment. The Microservices, Spring Boot, Angular, and Kubernetes stack described in the posting is the same stack I have shipped against at Rohde & Schwarz and the Federal Employment Agency. *That is the environment where I do my best work.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

Direct IoT or connected-device domain experience is not part of my background; my industrial context comes from FCAS (defence data platform) and manufacturing-site IT modernisation at Enercon. The transferable mechanic is the same: owning software that integrates with proprietary hardware ecosystems, managing external technology partners, and bridging business stakeholders who think in physical products with engineers who think in APIs.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and backlog refinement
 - **GPT**, stakeholder communication and edge-case generation
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-sprint spec and acceptance-criteria support
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, lightweight implementation validation
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for discovery artefacts
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and discovery read-outs
 - **n8n**, workflow automation and partner integration mapping
 - **Jira / Confluence**, backlog ownership and documentation (daily)
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Java and Kotlin with Spring Boot backends, Angular and AngularJS frontends, Python for ETL and data pipelines, PostgreSQL and MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD and Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, CGM API integration, low-code insurance platforms.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THIS COMPANY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Attend all three teams' ceremonies as observer, map current backlog health and dependency chains between POs, and identify where Discovery and Delivery processes break down – specifically which refinement steps are missing before tickets reach sprint.

WEEK 2

Stabilise the backlog.

Take ownership of my team's backlog, run a structured refinement session to surface ambiguity early, and establish a working definition-of-ready aligned with the other two POs.

Close the loops.

Drive the first full Discovery-to-Delivery cycle with external partner touchpoints included, introduce velocity tracking where it is absent, and document the process so it can be replicated across the other teams.

I COVER LETTER

Sehr geehrte Damen und Herren,

Etengo reached out about a Senior Product Owner role for a consumer-goods client scaling its connected professional-device platform across multiple interdisciplinary Scrum teams. I am writing because the brief matches my background with unusual precision.

At Emil Group I inherited a single bloated 17-person team, two frustrated clients, and a sprint cadence that had collapsed under delivery pressure. Within weeks I split the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, ran weekly product workshops, and reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure. The situation described in the posting – professionalising Discovery and Delivery processes, stabilising team structures, establishing clear PO roles across multiple teams – is the same problem I solved there.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a data management platform for the European defence programme FCAS, working in exactly the Microservices, Spring Boot, and Kubernetes environment your client uses. I delivered features end-to-end: from writing user stories and acceptance criteria through implementation support and testing to GitOps-based rollout via ArgoCD. I reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes. I also unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently when the development team was stuck, which gave me credibility with engineers that made backlog conversations substantially more efficient.

At the Federal Employment Agency I managed an analytics platform migration to Kubernetes while serving concurrently as Deputy IT Security Officer, which required close coordination with external partners and compliance stakeholders – the same partner-integration challenge your client is trying to systematise. My communication style is structured and direct in both German and English; I have given external product presentations in both languages, including an English-language product launch for Qcrypt AG's quantum-encryption hardware.

For this engagement I would bring: a working Scrum practice I can stand up quickly, experience aligning POs across teams on release dependencies, and technical fluency sufficient to challenge estimates, read architecture diagrams, and spot integration risks before they become sprint

failures. I am available from August 2026, comfortable working predominantly remote, and ready to discuss scope in a brief call.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Senior Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience owning software products end-to-end across complex, multi-stakeholder environments. Background spans agile SaaS platforms, government data systems, defence-sector AI infrastructure, and early-stage company building. Proven track record of stabilising Scrum delivery in distressed team situations, building Discovery processes from scratch, and maintaining technical credibility with engineering teams. Fluent in modern microservice-oriented stacks and experienced working as the central interface between business, development, UX, and external partners.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- End-to-end product ownership across Discovery and Delivery cycles
- Scrum team stabilisation and sprint discipline recovery
- Backlog structuring, refinement facilitation, and velocity tracking
- Cross-functional stakeholder alignment: business, engineering, UX, partners
- Technical fluency in Microservices, Spring Boot, Angular, Kubernetes stacks
- Dependency management and cross-team PO coordination
- Discovery process design under ambiguity
- External partner integration and coordination
- Workshop facilitation, German and English

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered features end-to-end in a Kotlin/Spring Boot and Kubernetes environment – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout via ArgoCD
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year
- Led a cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA across a multinational stakeholder group
- Owned data transformation, transparency, and auditability requirements for a European defence-programme platform (FCAS)

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Owned backlog and delivery for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform, including labour shortage analytics, regional comparison features, and modernised admin tooling
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades, coordinating closely with infrastructure partners
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV), covering compliance, governance, and data lineage – requiring structured coordination with external stakeholders
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration; introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability after complete breakdown: split a 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units and introduced clear ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient flows (anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, document storage) across iOS and Android on a tight timeline
 - Managed integration of CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, navigating legacy APIs and external database constraints
 - Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Co-founded and owned the product for a quantum-secure encryption system based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Designed the backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture with a target setup time under two minutes for non-technical users
- Served as deputy IT security officer, accountable for attack vector mitigation and security governance

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payment product; owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Product was later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE – ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex product catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policy workflows
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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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